

Information and privacy notice Expression of Interest

MultiAge: Language production in multilingual older adults living with cognitive impairment – Expression of Interest

Invitation and brief summary

We would like to invite you to take part in our research study, led by researchers at the University of York. The project lead is Dr Angela de Bruin, a Senior Lecturer in the Department of Psychology at the University of York.

In this study we look at how multilinguals use their languages. A multilingual is someone who can communicate in more than one language. We are especially interested in people who speak your language(s) and English. We are looking at how language differs between multilinguals living with or without cognitive impairment. People living with mild levels of cognitive impairment have problems with their memory and thinking that continue for more than a few months. Their memory and thinking are not working as well as expected for the person's age and background. These problems can include difficulties remembering recent events or learning new information, struggling to make decisions or work through everyday problems, finding it more difficult to focus on tasks, and/or having difficulties finding the right word when speaking. We here define "mild" as meaning that although the symptoms may be troubling, the person is still able to do most everyday activities.

Language changes can tell us something about changes in how people function. However, what we know about these language changes so far is based on research with people who speak only one language. In this study, we want to understand better how language changes in *multilinguals* who are living with cognitive impairment.

Participating in this study is entirely optional. Your decision to take part (or not) will not influence the care you receive. You can also stop the study at any time.

The study will take approximately 2 to 2.5 hours. We will do this in a location of your choice. We will explain each part of the task to you and will do everything together. In the main task, we will show you simple pictures. We then ask you to describe each picture using English and/or your language. We will also ask you some questions about your health and language background. We use a short interview to learn more about how you use your languages. Finally, we will do a few short tests to

look at how well you remember new information, respond to questions, and can pay attention to different things. You receive £25 and a few small gifts for taking part.

We are inviting you to take part if:

- You are between 60 and 75 years old
- You can have a conversation in Mirpuri-Pahari-Pothwari, and/or Punjabi/Panjabi, *and* English.
- You are living with cognitive impairment
- As a child, you did not have any language or reading difficulties such as stuttering or dyslexia
- You can see information on a computer screen and hear spoken information

If you are interested in taking part, we now ask you to complete a short form to share your contact details with us. We will ask you a few questions to make sure you are eligible to take part. If so, we will contact you and schedule a visit.

We are not asking you at this point to agree to take part in the full study. You can, however, already read the [information sheet for the full study](#)

(https://drive.google.com/file/d/1M4RPB0ESYwn_7JYzqUiFX3n5Q0I1LNDP/view?usp=sharing) or watch a [short video in your language](#) (<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BGiShluXGjo>).

Our contact details are:

University of York project team: Dr Angela de Bruin, Dr Zlatomira Ilchovska, Mr Imran Arif

Website: <https://multiage.github.io/>

Email address: multiage-project@york.ac.uk

Phone number: 07435017504

If you would like to sign up to receive more information about the study, please complete our short [expression of interest](#) (<https://forms.gle/AaDAbsCLrTx9PYQ49>) after reading this information. You can also call our project team to complete the expression of interest together.

In this expression of interest, we will use information from you, including your contact details and a few questions to make sure you are eligible. We will only use the information that we need for the research study. We will let very few people know your name or contact details, and only if they really need it for this study. In the reports we write, no-one can work out who you are. Everyone involved in this study will keep your personal data safe and secure. We will follow all privacy rules. At the end

of the study, we will save some of the data, in case we need to check it, for future research, and in line with the University of York's retention period.

We will make sure no-one can work out who you are from the reports we write.

The information pack tells you more about this.

What is involved in this study?

The background and purpose of the research

Multilinguals (people who speak more than one language) can speak words in one or multiple languages. Sometimes multilinguals use different languages within a conversation or even within a sentence. We call this "language switching". In this study, we want to know more about how language production and language switching differ between multilinguals who are living with cognitive impairment and multilinguals of similar ages without cognitive impairment.

Please call our multilingual project coordinator (07435017504) if you would like to receive more information in your language.

What would taking part involve?

For more information about the study itself, please see the full [information sheet for the full study](https://drive.google.com/file/d/1M4RPB0ESYwn_7JYzqUiFX3n5Q0I1LNDP/view?usp=sharing) (https://drive.google.com/file/d/1M4RPB0ESYwn_7JYzqUiFX3n5Q0I1LNDP/view?usp=sharing)

If you are interested in this study, we first ask you to complete our short expression of interest. This will ask you the following information:

- your contact details (so that we can get in touch),
- information to potentially schedule the study (for example, in which region you live)
- a few background questions (age, languages spoken, heritage region, and to confirm you meet our eligibility points). If you meet the eligibility points, a member of our research team will contact you afterwards to talk more about the study.

This project is a research study. Your decision to take part in the study does not influence the care you receive.

Your data will be saved on one of the University of York's approved, secure storage options. This can include use of Google Drive (the University of York has a GDPR compliant agreement in place) and other software approved by the University of York.

Who can take part in the research?

The eligibility points you will be asked to confirm are:

Age: You are between 60 and 75 years old. Please contact us if you are a few years younger or older than this age group and would like to take part.

Language:

- You speak English and Mirpuri-Pahari-Pothwari and/or Panjabi/Punjabi. By “speaking” we mean that you can have a conversation in each language.
- You use both languages at least sometimes in your daily life (you do not ONLY use English OR Mirpuri-Pahari-Pothwari and/or Panjabi/Punjabi in your daily life).

Health:

- You are living with cognitive impairment
- You did not have any language or reading disorders as a child (e.g., dyslexia or stuttering)
- You can see simple pictures on a computer screen. It is fine if you wear glasses or contact lenses.
- You can hear spoken information without difficulties. It is fine if you wear a hearing aid.

Do I have to take part?

No, participation is optional. We are now only asking you to share your contact information and some basic information about yourself. We will explain the study in more detail and you will then be asked to provide informed consent before the actual study starts. You can change your mind at any point. If you decide you do not want to take part and would like to remove your contact details, you can do this by contacting Dr Angela de Bruin at angela.debruin@york.ac.uk or by calling 07435017504.

What are the possible benefits of taking part?

There are no immediate personal benefits to taking part. This is the first time we are studying language production in your community. We therefore cannot give you individual feedback on your performance. This is a first research project to see how language might change in multilinguals living with cognitive impairment. We hope to use this research to find new ways to use language changes to tell us if someone might show signs of cognitive impairment. This can provide future benefits to multilingual communities like yours.

If you end up taking part in the actual study, you will receive £25 and a few small gifts.

Questions

If you have any questions now or in the future, please contact:

University of York project team: Dr Angela de Bruin, Dr Zlatomira Ilchovska, Mr Imran Arif

Website: <https://multiage.github.io/>

Email address: multiage-project@york.ac.uk

Phone number: 07435017504

If you have any concerns or complaints about how your data are used, please contact:

the University of York's data protection officer: dataprotection@york.ac.uk

Data Protection Officer, University of York, Heslington, York, YO10 5DD.

If you wish to make a complaint about the study to someone independent of the project from the University of York, please contact our local ethics committee (psyc529@york.ac.uk)

This project is funded by UKRI as part of the Horizon Europe guarantee scheme for selected ERC grants (Grant Number EP/Y036522/1)

This study has been reviewed by an independent group of people, called a Research Ethics Committee to protect your safety, rights, wellbeing, and dignity. This group includes both NHS staff and members of the public. This study has been reviewed and given favourable opinion by the NHS East Midlands - Derby Research Ethics Committee.

How will we process your data in line with UK General Data Protection Regulation (UK GDPR)?

Please see the [information sheet for the full study](https://drive.google.com/file/d/1M4RPB0ESYwn_7JYzqUiFX3n5Q0I1LNDP/view?usp=sharing)

(https://drive.google.com/file/d/1M4RPB0ESYwn_7JYzqUiFX3n5Q0I1LNDP/view?usp=sharing) for information about how we will process your data from the actual study. The information below only concerns this expression of interest.

How will we use information about you?

We will need to use information from you for this research project. This information will include:

- Your name and contact details so that we can send you more information and schedule a study visit.
- Your answers to our eligibility checks and some further information to schedule an appointment with you if you wish to take part.

People will use this information to do the research or to check your records to make sure that the research is being done properly.

People who do not need to know who you are will not be able to see your name or contact details. Your data will have a code number instead.

The University of York is the sponsor of this research. **The University of York** is responsible for looking after your information. We will not share your information related to this research project with any other organisations.

We will keep all information about you safe and secure by:

- We make sure only the study team will have access to your name and contact details at this point.
- We do not ask for more personal information about you than we need for this study.
- All personal information will be stored on University of York's secure and approved storage systems.

International transfers

Your data will not be shared outside the UK.

How will we use information about you after the study ends?

Once we have finished the study, we will keep some of the data so that we can check the results. We will write our reports in a way that no-one can work out that you took part in the study. We will keep your study data for the minimum period of time required to contact you to take part in the study. The study data will then be fully anonymised and securely archived or destroyed.

What are your choices about how your information is used?

You can stop being part of the study at any time, without giving a reason, but we will keep information about you that we already have. You have the right to ask us to access, remove, change or delete data we hold about you for the purposes of the study. You can also object to our processing of your data. We might not always be able to do this if it means we cannot use your data to do the research. If so, we will tell you why we cannot do this.

Where can you find out more about how your information is used?

You can find out more about how we use your information:

- our leaflet (<https://www.hra.nhs.uk/planning-and-improving-research/policies-standards-legislation/data-protection-and-information-governance/gdpr-guidance/templates/template-wording-for-generic-information-document/>) and University of York privacy notice for research participants (<https://www.york.ac.uk/records-management/dp/your-info/privacynotice-researchparticipants/>)
- by asking one of the research team
- by sending an email to multiage-project@york.ac.uk, or
- by ringing us on 07435017504.
- by contacting the University of York's data protection officer: dataprotection@york.ac.uk or Data Protection Officer, University of York, Heslington, York, YO10 5DD.